

1830–1837

PRINTS AND PATTERNS

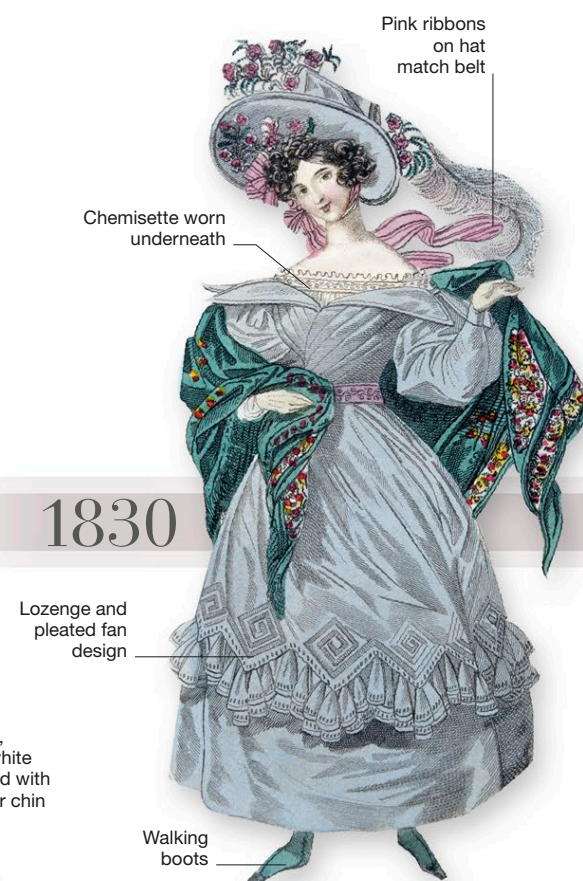
A number of recently evolved fashion features came to epitomize the new reign of Britain's King William IV and Queen Adelaide. The gigot sleeve had expanded to its fullest, and a lightly whaleboned corset was back in place. A tiny waistline was prized, with the waist at a more natural level. A small cushion pad sat in the small of the back. Separate pockets returned, and waist petticoats multiplied to support still fuller skirts. Patterned materials, particularly roller-printed China silks, soft cottons, and fine wools, were in vogue. Fashion was becoming accessible for the emergent middle classes, with import tax on silk reduced from 1825 and more ready-made goods available. Articles appeared in magazines to support home dressmaking. Girls were taught needlework skills such as piping and cartridge pleating. They stitched samplers to practise decorative borders and motifs, and alphabets for laundry marking. And they gathered a wedding trousseau in their bottom drawer.



Roller printing The fabric of this dress is roller printed by the mill-engraving technique, with two-colour, wavy lines. Further interest is created on sleeves and bodice through clever positioning of the printed material.



Pelisse-robe The pelisse (coat) of earlier decades developed into the pelisse-robe, which now fastened all down the front with concealed hooks and eyes. Here, these are covered with decorative bows and tassels.



1830

Square shawl A printed or woven border in the colours of an English country garden adorns this shawl worn folded diagonally, to wrap round bouffant sleeves. The outfit is completed with white kid gloves and green boots.



Rococo cloak Featuring a rococo design on figured material, this cloak with cape is trimmed and lined with darker wool or velvet material. The bonnet picks up the blue of the striped dress worn underneath.